O-C-303D
August 13, 1985
SUPERSEDING
O-C-303C
March 12, 1970

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHROMIUM TRIOXIDE, TECHNICAL

This specification is approved by the Assistant Administrator, Office of Federal Supply and Services, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers flake form, technical grade chromium trioxide, also known as chromic acid.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

NN-P-71	-	Pallets, Material Handling, Wood, Stringer Construction, 2-Way and 4-Way (Partial)
PPP-B-585	-	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-C-96	-	Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter
PPP-C-186	-	Containers, Packaging and Packing for Drugs, Chemicals, and Pharmaceuticals
PPP-D-729	-	Drums, Shipping and Storage, Steel, 55-Gallon (208 Liters)
PPP-F-320	-	Fiberboard; Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade) and Cut Shapes
PPP-T-66	-	Tape, Packaging, Vinyl Plastic Film

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123	-	Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)
Fed. Std. No. 313	-	Material Safety Data Sheets Preparation and the Submission Of

FSC 6810

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads

(Copies of military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Code of Federal Regulations (CFR)

49 CFR 171 to 179 - Hazardous Materials Regulations

(The Code of Federal Regulations and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

ASTM Standards:

C 516 - Vermiculite Loose Fill Thermal Insulation
D 1193 - Reagent Water
E 11 - Wire-Cloth Sieves for Testing Purposes
E 29 - Indicating Which Places of Figures are to be Considered Significant in Specified Limiting Values

(Application for copies should be addressed to ASTM, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards), the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Appearance. Chromium trioxide shall be free-flowing, reddish-brown flakes, free from lumps, when tested as specified in 4.2.4.1.

3.2 Chemical characteristics. Chromium trioxide shall conform to the chemical characteristics of table I when tested as specified therein.

TABLE I. Chemical characteristics

Characteristic	Percent by weight		Test paragraph
	Minimum	Maximum	
Assay (as CrO_3)	99.5	----	4.2.4.2
Sulfate (SO_4)	----	0.20	4.2.4.3
Chloride (Cl)	----	0.10	4.2.4.4
Insoluble matter	----	0.10	4.2.4.5

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3.3 Particle size. No more than 30 percent by weight of the chromium trioxide shall pass through a standard 600-micrometer sieve when tested as specified in 4.2.4.6.

3.4 Material Safety Data Sheets. Material Safety Data Sheets for chromium trioxide shall be prepared and submitted by the contractor as specified in Fed. Std. No. 313 (see 6.4).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection.

4.2.1 Lotting. A lot shall consist of the chromium trioxide produced by one manufacturer, at one plant, from the same materials, and under essentially the same manufacturing conditions provided the operation is continuous. In the event the process is a batch operation, each batch shall constitute a lot (see 6.3).

4.2.2 Sampling.

4.2.2.1 For examination of packaging. Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-4.

4.2.2.2 For chromium trioxide test. See 6.5 for sampling and testing precautions. Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with table II. A representative specimen of approximately 200 grams (g) shall be removed from each sample container and placed in a suitable clean, dry container labeled to identify the lot and container from which it was taken.

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TABLE II. Sampling for chromium trioxide test

Number of containers in batch or lot	Number of sample containers
2 to 25	2
26 to 150	3
151 to 1,200	5
1,201 to 7,000	8
7,001 to 20,000	10
Over 20,000	20

4.2.2.3 For container leakage test. Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-4.

4.2.3 Inspection procedure.

4.2.3.1 For examination of packaging. The sample unit shall be one filled unit or shipping container, as applicable, ready for shipment. Sample unit and shipping containers shall be examined for the following defects:

AQL 1.0 percent defective

(a) Container damaged or leaking

AQL 2.5 percent defective

(b) Contents per container not as specified
(c) Container not as specified
(d) Container closure not as specified
(e) Vermiculite cushioning missing or not as specified (when required)
(f) Fiberboard pads and liners missing or not as specified (when required)
(g) Unitization not as specified
(h) Marking incorrect, missing or illegible

4.2.3.2 For chromium trioxide test. Each sample specimen taken in 4.2.2.2 shall be tested as specified in 4.2.4. Failure of any test by any specimen shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented.

4.2.3.3 For container leakage test. See 6.5 for sampling and testing precautions. The sample unit shall be one filled container. The sample containers selected in 4.2.2.3 shall be tested as specified in 4.2.5 using an AQL of 1.5 percent defective.

4.2.3.4 Significant places. For the purpose of determining conformance with this specification, an observed or calculated value shall be rounded off "to the nearest unit" in the last right-hand place of figures used in expressing the limiting value, in accordance with the rounding-off method of ASTM E 29.

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4.2.4 Chromium trioxide tests. See 6.5 for sampling and testing precautions. Water in accordance with ASTM D 1193 and reagent grade chemicals shall be used throughout the tests. Where applicable, blank determinations shall be run and corrections applied where significant. Tests shall be conducted as follows:

4.2.4.1 Appearance. Visually examine the specimen for color, form, lumps, and flowing characteristics.

4.2.4.2 Assay (as CrO_3). Weigh to the nearest milligram approximately 5 g of the specimen into a 1-liter volumetric flask. Dissolve in water and then dilute to make 1-liter of solution. Mix the solution thoroughly. Transfer a 25.0-milliliter (mL) aliquot of the solution to a glass-stoppered bottle and dilute with 100 mL of water. Add 5 mL of 1 to 1 sulfuric acid and 3 g of potassium iodide and allow to stand in the dark for 15 minutes. Dilute with another 100 mL of water and titrate the liberated iodine with approximately 0.1N sodium thiosulfate solution, which has been standardized. Add starch solution as an indicator toward the end of the titration. Calculate the percent by weight chromium trioxide as CrO_3 as follows:

$$\text{Percent chromium trioxide} = \frac{133.36A(B - C)}{W}$$

where: A = Normality of sodium thiosulfate solution,
B = Milliliters of sodium thiosulfate solution used,
C = Milliliters of sodium thiosulfate solution consumed in a blank test made with the same quantities of reagents, and
W = Weight of specimen in grams.

4.2.4.3 Sulfate. Weigh to the nearest milligram approximately 9 g of the specimen. Dissolve in 50 mL of cold water and filter the solution to remove any insoluble matter. To the filtrate add 7 mL of concentrated hydrochloric acid, 40 to 50 mL of glacial acetic acid, and 25 to 30 mL of ethanol. After vigorous action has stopped, heat to boiling and boil for 10 to 15 minutes. Dilute to 200 mL with water, heat to boiling again, add 7 to 8 mL of 10-percent barium chloride solution drop by drop, and keep the solution hot for 5 to 6 hours. Filter the solution through a tared filter crucible which has been weighed to the nearest milligram, and wash the precipitate first with 1 to 100 hydrochloric acid and then with hot water. Dry at 105° ± 2°C for 30 minutes and then ignite the precipitate over a Bunsen burner for 30 minutes. Cool in a desiccator and weigh to the nearest milligram. Calculate the percent by weight sulfate as follows:

$$\text{Percent sulfate} = \frac{41.2(A - B)}{W}$$

where: A = Weight of crucible and precipitate in grams,
B = Weight of crucible in grams, and
W = Weight of specimen in grams.

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4.2.4.4 Chloride. Weigh to the nearest milligram approximately 10 g of the specimen, dissolve in 100 mL of water, and heat on a steam bath for 1 hour. Filter through a filter crucible, wash the residue with four 20-mL portions of hot water and transfer the filtrate quantitatively to a 250-mL volumetric flask. Cool to room temperature and dilute with water to make 250 mL. Mix thoroughly, transfer 125 mL of the solution to a 500-mL beaker, and add 50 mL of concentrated nitric acid. Warm the solution to 50° ± 2°C and add, drop by drop, 5 drops of 10 percent silver nitrate solution. Allow the precipitate to settle in the dark and then filter through a tared filter crucible which has been weighed to the nearest milligram. Wash three times: first with water containing a little nitric acid and twice with ethanol or water to remove the acid. Dry and weigh to the nearest milligram. Calculate the percent by weight chloride as follows:

$$\text{Percent chloride} = \frac{49.5(A - B)}{W}$$

where: A = Weight of crucible and insoluble matter in grams,
B = Weight of crucible in grams, and
W = Weight of specimen in grams.

4.2.4.5 Insoluble matter. Weigh to the nearest milligram approximately 10 g of the specimen. Dissolve in 100 mL of water and heat on a steam bath for 1 hour. Filter through a tared filter crucible which has been weighed to the nearest milligram, wash with four 20-mL portions of hot water, dry to a constant weight at 105° ± 2°C, cool in a desiccator and weigh to the nearest milligram. Calculate the percent by weight insoluble matter as follows:

$$\text{Percent insoluble matter} = \frac{100(A - B)}{W}$$

where: A = Weight of crucible and insoluble matter in grams,
B = Weight of crucible in grams, and
W = Weight of specimen in grams.

4.2.4.6 Particle size. Weigh to the nearest 0.1 g approximately 100 g of the specimen and place on a 600-micrometer sieve conforming to ASTM E 11 except that the sieve shall be made of stainless steel, equipped with a bottom pan. Cover the sieve and shake for 5 minutes by means of mechanical shaker geared to produce 300 ± 15 gyrations and 150 ± 10 taps of the shaker per minute. Weigh the portion collected on the bottom pan and calculate the percent passing.

4.2.5 Container leakage tests.

4.2.5.1 Air leakage. Submerge the container in water heated to a temperature at least 50°F above the initial temperature of the specimen. While holding the specimen submerged with the uppermost surface covered by not more than 25 millimeters of water, observe for at least 15 seconds to detect leakage. Leakage is defined as a succession of bubbles. Rotate and observe the specimen

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repeatedly until all of the specimen has been examined. Total time in hot water should not exceed 8 minutes. Record the locations of any leaks or state "no leaks".

4.2.5.2 Drum leakage. Place the drum on its side, roll it a distance equivalent to twice its circumference, and observe for leakage. Any leakage of contents constitutes failure.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Unit packing. Chromium trioxide shall be unit packed level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Chromium trioxide shall be unit packed level A in a 5- or 100-pound (lb) quantity as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1.1 Five-lb quantity. A quantity of 5 (+1/4 or -0) lb of chromium trioxide shall be unit packed level A in a clean, dry, close-fitting, wide-mouth, glass bottle with screw-cap closure, cushioned by vermiculite in a slip-cover tin-plate can. The bottle shall conform to class 1, type optional glass, style 2, grade optional, screw-cap closure B and outer seal A of PPP-C-186. The liner and facing of the screw-cap shall be highly resistant to chromium trioxide. The can shall be of a size to allow a minimum thickness of 1/2 inch of vermiculite cushioning to be applied between the bottle and can surfaces. The can shall conform to type VI, slip cover, of PPP-C-96, shall be formed of number 100 electrolytic tinplate and shall be coated plan B with side seam striped. The filled bottle shall be closed to a torque within the range recommended by the bottle manufacturer, and shall not leak when tested for leakage of air as specified in 4.2.5.1. The outer seal shall then be applied. The bottle with label affixed shall then be centered in the can closure, end upright, on a cushioning of vermiculite. Vermiculite shall then be poured around and over the bottle completely filling the can, preventing movement of contents when the can cover is secured in place. Vermiculite shall conform to grade 1 or 2 of ASTM C 516. The cover shall be secured to the can by minimum 1 inch wide tape conforming to type and class optional of PPP-T-66. The tape shall be applied along, and centered over the seam between the can body and its cover, completely sealing the seam.

5.1.1.2 One hundred-lb quantity. A quantity of 100 (+1 or -0) lb of chromium trioxide shall be unit packed in a clean, dry removable head steel drum. The drum shall conform to Department of Transportation (DOT) Specification 17C, 17E, or 37A. No preservative oil or other organic coating shall be permitted on the interior of the drum. The exterior of the drum shall be cleaned, finished and painted as specified for the drum of PPP-D-729. The drum shall be tightly closed. There shall be no leakage of chromium trioxide from the drum when tested as specified in 4.2.5.2.

5.1.2 Level B. Chromium trioxide shall be unit packed level B in a 5- or 100-lb quantity as specified (see 6.2).

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5.1.2.1 Five-lb quantity. A quantity of 5 (+1/4 or -0) lb of chromium trioxide shall be packed level B in a clean, dry, tin-plate screw-cap can. The can shall conform to type V, class 4 with a minimum 1-1/4 inch diameter screw-cap closure of PPP-C-96. The can shall be of a minimum size to contain the chromium trioxide, and the liner and facing of the screw-cap shall be highly resistant to chromium trioxide. The screw-cap shall be closed to a torque within the range recommended by the can manufacturer. There shall be no leakage of air from the can when tested as specified in 4.2.5.1.

5.1.2.2 One hundred-lb quantity. The 100-lb quantity of chromium trioxide shall be unit packed level B in the same manner as specified for level A in 5.1.1.2.

5.1.3 Level C. The 5- or 100-lb quantity of chromium trioxide as specified (see 6.2) shall be unit packed in a manner to preserve the originally specified quantity and quality for a minimum duration of 6 months. Containers shall be in accordance with all regulatory requirements applicable to the intended mode of transportation.

5.2 Packing. Chromium trioxide shall be packed level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Five-lb quantity. Four 5-lb containers of chromium trioxide, unit packed as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be packed level A with closure ends upright in a close-fitting wirebound wood box. All inside faces of the box shall be completely lined with fiberboard and each can shall be placed within a close-fitting cell formed by partitions of full-can-height fiberboard. Motion of contents within the box shall be prevented by inserting fiberboard pads as needed. The box shall conform to class 3, style optional of PPP-B-585. The fiberboard shall conform to grade V3c of PPP-F-320. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-585.

5.2.1.2 One hundred-lb quantity. The 100-lb quantity of chromium trioxide, unit packed level A as specified in 5.1.1.2, shall require no further protection for shipment other than unitization.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Five-lb quantity. The 5-lb quantity of chromium trioxide shall be packed level B in the same manner as specified for level A in 5.2.1.1, except that the box shall be a close-fitting box conforming to grade V3c of PPP-B-636. The box shall be closed as specified for the closure of boxes intended as exterior containers, in the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.2 One hundred-lb quantity. The 100-lb quantity, unit packed as specified in 5.1.2.2, shall require no further protection for shipment.

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5.2.3 Level C. Uniform quantities of the 5- or 100-lb quantity of chromium trioxide shall be packed level C in a manner to assure protection of the chromium trioxide during transit to first destination and during storage for a minimum duration of 6 months. Containers shall be acceptable to common carrier and in accordance with DOT regulations. Containers shall also be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules, National Motor Freight Classification Rules and the rules and regulations applicable to any other intended mode of transportation.

5.3 Unitization. Uniform quantities of like packs of chromium trioxide shall be palletized in accordance MIL-STD-147, using the softwood pallet conforming to type IV of NN-P-71. Boxes shall be palletized using load type I of MIL-STD-147, and drums shall be palletized using load type IV of MIL-STD-147.

5.4 Marking. Unit packs and packs shall be marked in accordance with DOT regulations and MIL-STD-129 for military activities or in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 and DOT regulations for civil agencies. In addition, each container shall be marked to show lot or batch number and date of manufacture of chromium trioxide, and shall show the bar-code and the following precautionary information:

CHROMIUM TRIOXIDE
(CHROMIC ACID)
DANGER! STRONG OXIDIZER

CONTACT WITH OTHER MATERIAL MAY CAUSE FIRE
MAY CAUSE BURNS OR EXTERNAL ULCERS

Keep container closed.
Do not get in eyes, on skin, or on clothing.
Do not breathe dust or mist from solution.
Do not store near combustible material. In case of fire, extinguish with water.
In case of contact, immediately flush skin or eyes with plenty of water for at least 15 minutes; for eyes, get medical attention. Wash clothing before reuse.
Use fresh clothing daily. Take hot shower after work using plenty of soap.

Each shipping container shall also bear the yellow Department of Transportation label.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Chromium trioxide is intended for use in the surface treatment of metals, in chromium plating, and in the anodic oxidation process for aluminum and aluminum alloys.

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6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification
(b) Level of unit packing and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2)
(c) Quantity to be unit packed level A (see 5.1.1)
(d) Quantity to be unit packed level B (see 5.1.2)
(e) Quantity to be unit packed level C (see 5.1.3)

6.3 Batch. A batch is defined as that quantity of material which has been manufactured by some unit chemical process or subjected to some physical mixing operation intended to make the final product substantially uniform.

6.4 Material Safety Data Sheets. Contracting officers will identify those activities requiring copies of completed Material Safety Data Sheets prepared in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 313. The pertinent mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. No. 313.

6.5 Sampling and testing precautions. This specification requires inspection of chemical material (chromium trioxide, strong oxidizer) which is potentially hazardous to personnel. All applicable safety rules, regulations and procedures must be followed in the handling and processing of this material.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - EA
Air Force - 68

Review activities:

Army - AR, MD, ME, MI
DLA - GS
Other - DS

User activities:

Army - ER
Navy - AS, OS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

AGR-APS
COM-NBS
GSA-7FCE
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Preparing activity:

Army - EA

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	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
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